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Global Macro Commentary | Global

October 27: Trade Tensions Thaw

US & China signal progress towards trade agreement; US trade agreements in Southeast Asia; US extends tariff deadline for Mexico but proposes 10% increase on Canada; Milei's party wins Argentina midterms; US rates concession before front-end auctions; DXY at 98.78 (-0.2%); US 10y at 3.98 (-2.1bp).

Heading into a week of major central bank meetings, risk sentiment rebounds on the back of constructive signals from US-China trade talks over the weekend.

Developed Markets

- **Front-end Treasuries sell off in a concession ahead of the 2y and 5y auctions, while long-end yields drift lower (30y: -4bp) despite strong risk sentiment.** Both auctions stop close to the screws, resulting in front-end yields remaining elevated (2y: +1bp) through the afternoon. The long end outperforms, with the flattening move potentially supported by positioning on the curve into the front-end supply. Ahead of Wednesday's FOMC meeting, Treasury Secretary Bessent [confirms](#) five remaining candidates for the next Fed chair: Waller, Bowman, Warsh, Hassett, and Rieder. Labor market concerns remain in focus amid rumors of corporate [layoffs](#) and [hiring slowdowns](#) related to AI.
- **US equities rally 1.2% following positive readouts of the weekend's preliminary talks between US and Chinese officials.** President Trump [says](#) he "really feels good" about reaching a deal with Chinese President Xi when they meet on October 30. In line with our [expectations](#) for a limited US-China agreement, Treasury Secretary Bessent says the proposed 100% tariff is "off the table," potentially in exchange for China purchasing US soybeans and delaying its rare earth licensing regime "for a year." According to officials from both sides, other areas for discussion could include export controls, shipping fees, and fentanyl-related tariffs. Tech and other cyclical stocks (Communication Services: +2.3%; IT: +2.0%) lead the rally, while defensive sectors lag (Consumer Staples: -0.3%).
- **Risk-sensitive currencies exposed to trade with China lead gains among the G10 (AUD/USD: +0.7%; NZD/USD: +0.3%).** Safe-haven currencies underperform the move against the dollar, with CHF and JPY closing largely unchanged. Similarly, gold prices slide another 3% below the \$4,000/oz threshold as safe-haven demand diminishes.
- **USD/CAD holds steady even as the US proposes additional 10% tariffs on Canada.** Market participants seemingly take into account the undefined

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implementation timeline and that most Canadian goods are exempt from US tariffs under the USMCA. Elsewhere in the G10, UK gilts bull-flatten (2y: -2bp; 30y: -4bp) and GBP outperforms (GBP/USD: +0.2%) on easing fiscal concerns as Chancellor Reeves [maintains](#) that tax hikes are a viable option to achieve fiscal goals in the Autumn Budget.

- **Duration rallies in the euro area, though front-end German bunds underperform (2y: +0bp) after the ifo Business Climate survey shows better-than-expected sentiment among German companies.** The flattening move is even more pronounced in EUR swaps, where 2s10s flattens by more than 2bp. EGB spreads tighten, particularly in Italy, where the 10y BTP-Bund spread narrows more than 1bp.
- **Japanese rates modestly bear-steepen (5y: +1bp; 30y: +3bp) on strong risk sentiment following the US-China trade talks, with the long end seemingly weighed down by political uncertainty ahead of this week's US-Japan summit.** In particular, market participants are focused on the possibility of increased defense spending as a potential policy concession to the US. Despite a rally in local equities (Nikkei: +2.5%), USD/JPY remains range-bound in light of the upcoming BoJ and FOMC meetings.

Emerging Markets

- **Asian rates broadly sell off on strong risk sentiment in the wake of the US-China trade talks.** However, Chinese rates rally, with CNY NDIRS yields falling 4bp after the PBoC signals that it will resume government bond trading operations. CNH strengthens 0.3% to 7.105 per USD, aided by a lower USD/CNY fixing (7.0881; P: 7.0928). Meanwhile, Korean rates bear-steepen (10y KRW NDIRS: +5bp) amid the risk-on rotation, with local equities rallying sharply (KOSPI: +2.6%) even as the US and Korea [reiterate](#) that a bilateral trade deal is unlikely to be finalized before Wednesday.
- **Malaysia and Thailand see currency strength and rates weakness after both countries sign trade agreements with the US.** In Malaysia, MYR rallies 0.3% and the 5y MYR NDIRS yield rises 4bp. In Thailand, rates also sell off (5y THB NDIRS: +3bp), but USD/THB holds steady at ~32.7 as trade optimism is offset by the aforementioned decline in gold prices. Meanwhile, INR and PHP both weaken 0.5% against USD amid unconfirmed reports of increased USD demand from Indian importers, as well as dovish comments from BSP in the Philippines (see below).
- **LatAm assets rally alongside the broader risk-on rotation across global markets, as well as constructive US trade developments in Brazil and Mexico.** BRL leads regional FX strength after the weekend [meeting](#) between Brazilian President Lula and US President Trump, described as positive by both parties. MXN also gains 0.3% against USD as Mexican President Sheinbaum [announces](#) that the US has extended its deadline for higher tariffs — originally set to take effect November 1 — by "several weeks" to

allow for continued negotiations. In Chile, CLP's recent momentum stalls, closing flat against USD.

- **In Argentina, markets rally sharply after President Milei's party wins the midterm legislative election, likely providing enough votes to implement Milei's proposed fiscal reforms.** ARGENT'35 gains nearly 12 cash points, ARS gains 4% against USD, and local equities (MERVAL) rally 22%. Our economists [believe](#) the composition of the new government provides an opportunity to implement more sustained supply-side reforms.
- **Meanwhile, Colombia's curve sees mild bear steepening amid political noise surrounding the 2026 elections** and the initial candidate selection process, with turnout in the [left-wing primaries](#) exceeding historical levels at nearly 3 million voters. [Senator Cepeda](#) securing 65% of the vote, signaling stronger-than-expected mobilization.
- **In a quiet session, CEEMEA currencies strengthen in line with the broader move against USD.** Hungary outperforms, with EUR/HUF closing the London session 0.4% lower. In Turkey, TRY weakens 0.1-0.2% against USD and EUR following a slight upside surprise in Turkey's unemployment rate (8.6%; P: 8.5%).

Central Bank Monitor

Emerging Markets

- In China, **PBoC Governor Pan** [said](#) the central bank will resume government bond trading operations, citing the current "sound" conditions of the overall bond market. He said the PBoC had paused bond trading earlier this year due to imbalance in bond supply and demand.
- In Philippines, **BSP Board Member Diokno** [said](#) he expects the central bank to lower its policy rate by another 25bp at its December meeting, with further cuts in 2026 possible depending on growth and employment data, as inflation is "pretty much under control." He reiterated the BSP does not target a specific exchange rate and only intervenes if it would affect the inflation target. He suggested the BSP should consider selling some of its gold holdings, which he views as excessive given that gold should ideally comprise 8-12% of the central bank's FX reserves. He revealed the BSP is still debating whether it should diversify the currencies in its FX reserves, possibly including EUR.

Exhibit 1: G4 Rates Closes (5pm NY)

Tenor	US			Germany			UK			Japan		
	27-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	27-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	27-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	27-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
2y	3.491	1.1		1.970	0.3		3.776	(1.6)		0.939	1.3	
3y	3.491	0.3		2.024	0.5		3.764	(1.7)		1.010	0.4	
5y	3.602	(0.4)		2.226	(0.4)		3.881	(1.9)		1.231	1.5	
7y	3.774	(1.3)		2.360	(0.7)		4.005	(2.8)		1.445	0.8	
10y	3.980	(2.1)		2.615	(1.0)		4.401	(3.0)		1.666	1.4	
20y	4.527	(3.5)		3.084	(1.8)		5.061	(3.4)		2.604	1.0	
30y	4.552	(4.1)		3.188	(1.7)		5.180	(3.8)		3.074	2.1	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 2: Inflation Closes (5pm NY)

Tenor	US TIPS			10y Real Yields, BEI			10y	27-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
	27-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	27-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk				
5y	1.220	1.5		DBRi	0.660	(1.0)	BTPi	1.712	(1.5)	
BEI	2.377	(2.0)		BEI	1.752	0.2	BEI	1.702	(0.8)	
10y	1.692	(0.9)		UKTi	1.549	(0.1)				
BEI	2.287	(1.2)		BEI	2.920	(3.1)				
30y	2.338	(2.9)		JGBi	0.047	0.5				
BEI	2.216	(1.1)		BEI	1.591	0.7				

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 3: Macro Closes (5pm NY)

Spot	Majors			Spot	EM			Index	Equities / Commodities		
	27-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk		27-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk		27-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk
DXY	98.78	(0.2)		CNH	7.11	(0.2)		S&P	6875.16	1.2	
EUR	1.165	0.2		INR	88.24	0.4		Stoxx	5711.06	0.6	
GBP	1.334	0.2		THB	32.71	(0.2)		FTSE	9653.82	0.1	
JPY	152.88	0.0		KRW	1432.90	(0.4)		Nikkei	50512.32	2.5	
CHF	0.796	(0.0)		ZAR	17.22	(0.3)		VIX	15.79	(3.5)	
AUD	0.656	0.7		MXN	18.40	(0.3)		Gold (S)	3982.21	(3.2)	
CAD	1.399	(0.0)		BRL	5.37	(0.3)		WTI (Fut)	61.31	(0.3)	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 4: G4 Central Bank Implied Pricing

Fed	Central Bank OIS				ECB	Central Bank OIS				BOE	Central Bank OIS				BOJ	Central Bank OIS			
	Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ			Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ			Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ			Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ	
EFFR (10/24)	4.110	0.0			EDNIA (10/24)	1.928	0.0			SONIA (10/24)	3.969	0.0			TONAR (10/24)	0.477	0.0		
10/29/25	3.858	(0.5)	(25.2)		10/30/25	1.926	0.1	(0.2)		11/06/25	3.904	(0.7)	(6.5)		10/30/25	0.503	0.0	2.6	
12/10/25	3.618	1.4	(49.2)		12/18/25	1.915	0.2	(1.3)		12/18/25	3.811	0.0	(15.8)		12/19/25	0.589	(0.9)	11.2	
01/28/26	3.487	2.0	(62.3)		02/05/26	1.893	0.3	(3.5)		02/05/26	3.665	1.3	(30.4)		01/23/26	0.692	0.1	21.5	
03/18/26	3.377	2.5	(73.3)		03/19/26	1.854	0.3	(7.4)		03/19/26	3.608	1.0	(36.1)						
04/29/26	3.313	2.5	(79.8)		04/30/26	1.840	(0.1)	(8.8)		04/30/26	3.494	0.7	(47.5)						
06/17/26	3.181	2.3	(92.9)		06/11/26	1.813	0.7	(11.5)		06/18/26	3.465	1.2	(50.4)						

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Economic Releases*Developed Markets*

- **Germany October Ifo Business Climate:** 88.4 (MSe: 88.0; C: 88.0; P: 87.7)

Emerging Markets

- **Thailand September Customs Trade Balance:** \$1.275bn (C: -\$199mn; P: -\$1.964bn); **Customs Exports:** 19.0% y/y (C: 7.2%; P: 5.8%) & **Customs Imports:** 17.2% y/y (C: 10.4%; P: 15.8%)
- **Taiwan September Unemployment Rate:** 3.35% (MSe: 3.40%; C: 3.40%; P: 3.35%)
- **Hong Kong September Trade Balance:** -HK\$50.2bn (C: -HK\$49.5bn;

P: -HK\$25.4bn); **Exports:** 16.1% y/y (C: 15.4%; P: 14.5%) & **Imports:** 13.6% y/y (C: 13.5%; P: 11.5%)

- **Turkey September Unemployment Rate:** 8.6% (P: 8.5%)
- **Turkey October Capacity Utilization:** 74.2% (P: 74.0%)
- **Israel September Unemployment Rate:** 3.0% (P: 2.9%)
- **Israel September Trade Balance:** -USD3424mn (P: -USD3366)

The Day Ahead

Developed Markets

- Mon 8:00pm EST - **UK October BRC Shop Price Index** (MSe: 1.5% y/y, 1.6%, 1.4%). We assume some softening in core goods and food pressures to be captured by the BRC index, which tends to be sampled early in the month
- Tue 7:00am BST - **Germany November GfK Consumer Confidence** (MS: -22.1; C: -22; P: -22.3)
- 9:30am BST - **ECB Governing Council member Panetta** will speak in Rome
- 9:00am EST - **US August S&P Cotality CS 20-City** (MSe: 3.1% m/m ; C: -0.1%; P: -0.1%). In the S&P/Case-Shiller home price indexes, monthly prices have been declining since the beginning of the year. As of July, the annual increase slowed to 1.8%, down from 5.9% in the same month last year.
- 10:00am EST - **US October Conference Board Consumer Confidence** (C: 93.4; P: 94.2). The labor market differential has declined this year, reaching 7.8% in September. While this is low compared to recent years, it remains above levels seen during parts of previous expansions. Consumer confidence has been relatively stable since May, though it fell by 3.6 points to 94.2 in September. For reference, the average in 2024 was 104.5.

Emerging Markets

- Tue 5:00pm EST - **Chile BCCh Monetary Policy Decision** (MSe: 4.75%; P: 4.75%; C: 4.75%) We expect BCCh to hold rates. Persistent core inflation supports a cautious stance, while near-neutral monetary conditions and stronger domestic demand reduce urgency for further easing. Markets are pricing ~13bps of cuts for December and ~22bps from January to October 2026, with a terminal rate of ~4.40%. [Read more](#)
- 7:00am HKT - **Korea 3Q25 Advance GDP** (MSe: 1.7% y/y; C: 1.5% y/y; P: 0.6% y/y)
- 6:30pm HKT - **India September Industrial Production** (C: 2.9% y/y; P: 4.0%)
- 8:00am EST - **Mexico September Unemployment Rate NSA** (P: 2.93%; C: 2.86%) Consensus expects a modest decline, reinforcing labor market resilience. Despite this strength, Banxico easing remains priced in, with ~41bps of cuts through year-end and ~32bps in 2026, implying a terminal rate near 6.77% by March.

For more details, please refer to our economists' weekly reports and data previews:

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G4 Smarter (Beta) Trading Partners

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Since 2000, enhancements to a G4 10y government bond futures momentum strategy have produced higher Sharpe ratios and stronger returns relative to total return government bond indices for the G4: US, Germany, Japan, and the UK. See [A "Smarter" \(Beta\) Way to Trade G4 10y Futures Duration?](#) for more information on these strategies.

Exhibit 5: Trading Signals for G4 Smarter (beta) Trading Strategy

Current Risk, G4 10y Futures	G4 Strategy Weight	Trade Longs Portfolio	Fade Shorts Portfolio	Total Risk Trade Longs Only	Total Risk Trade Longs/Fade Shorts (max 200%)	Trade Longs Portfolio Entry Date	Trade Longs Portfolio Exit Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Entry Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Exit Date
J8 10y Future	32.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/15/2025	11/20/2025	9/19/2025	10/28/2025
GE 10y Future	29.25%	100%	0%	100%	100%	10/7/2025	11/11/2025	-	-
US 10y Future	30.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/14/2025	11/19/2025	9/24/2025	10/30/2025
UK 10y Future	7.75%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/15/2025	11/19/2025	9/25/2025	10/30/2025

Source: Morgan Stanley Research

Trading Strategy 1 – "Trade Longs/Fade Shorts"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract and hold for a 25-business-day period. In short, this strategy buys futures when the Simple Moving Average Crossover (SMAX) generates both a long and a short signal, given the historical outperformance of long signals traded long and the underperformance of short signals traded short. Given that the SMAX could generate both a long and a short signal within the predefined holding period, an investor may have a 200% long position since each of the two signals would be traded in separate portfolio sleeves.

Trading Strategy 2 – Trade "Longs Only"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, do nothing. In short, an investor *only* trades long signals initiated by the SMAX given their historical precedent to outperform.

US Holiday Trading Strategy

Currently Active Strategies

None.

Combining the individual trading signals based on 10y Treasury future (TY) price patterns before and after US holidays has generated an annual strategy with no down years since 1987. See [Trading 10y Treasury Futures Around US Holidays](#) for more information.

Using historical data since 1983, we created a trading strategy using 10y Treasury futures (TY) that trades 11 times per year, either long or short, before or after the following US holidays: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Day, Presidents' Day, Good Friday, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Columbus Day, Thanksgiving, and Christmas. [Exhibit 6](#) displays the trading rules:

Exhibit 6: Trading rules for US holiday trading model using US 10y futures contracts (TY)

Holiday	Day of Week	Direction	Before/After Holiday	Trading Rule (business days, 3pm NY unless specified)	Trade Entry (business days)	Trade Exit (business days)
New Year's Day	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY New Years +1, Sell TY New Years +4	New Year + 1	New Year + 4
Martin Luther King Day 1	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Tuesday before MLK, Sell Friday before MLK	MLK - 4	MLK - 1
Martin Luther King Day 2	Monday	Short TY	After	Sell TY Tuesday after MLK, Buy Friday after MLK	MLK + 1	MLK + 4
President's Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Pres. Day, Sell TY Friday after Pres. Day	Pres. Day + 1	Pres. Day + 4
Good Friday	Friday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Monday after Good Friday, Sell TY Friday after Good Friday	Good Friday + 1	Good Friday + 5
Memorial Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Mem. Day, Sell TY Friday after Mem. Day	Mem. Day + 1	Mem. Day + 4
Independence Day (July 4th)	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY Independence Day + 2, Sell TY Independence Day + 4	Ind. Day + 2	Ind. Day + 4
Labor Day	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Monday before Labor Day, Sell TY Thursday before Labor Day	Labor Day - 4	Labor Day - 2
Columbus Day	Monday	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Monday before Col. Day, Buy TY Thursday before Col. Day	Colum. Day - 5	Colum. Day - 2
Thanksgiving	Thursday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Friday before Thanksgiving, Sell TY Tuesday before Thanksgiving	Thanksgiving - 4	Thanksgiving - 2
Christmas	Rotates	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Christmas Day - 4, Buy TY Christmas Day - 1	Christmas - 4	Christmas - 1

Source: Morgan Stanley Research. Note: Past performance is no guarantee of future results.

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(as of September 30, 2025)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1499	41%	389	46%	26%	702	41%
Equal-weight/Hold	1618	44%	375	44%	23%	782	45%
Not-Rated/Hold	4	0%	1	0%	25%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	577	16%	88	10%	15%	234	14%
Total	3,698		853			1719	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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